MENGYING WU
mengying_wu@hks.harvard.edu
617-800-4032
https://mengyingmandywu.github.io/

HARVARD UNIVERSITY

Address Belfer Center 317, 79 John F. Kennedy St, Cambridge, MA 02138

Academic Appointments

Harvard University (2023 – Present)
Postdoctoral Fellow, Environment and Natural Resources Program, Harvard Kennedy School Belfer Center & Salata Institute for Climate and Sustainability

Carnegie Mellon University (2022 – 2023)
Postdoctoral Associate, Department of Engineering and Public Policy
Visiting Researcher, Institute of Energy, Environment, and Economy, Tsinghua University (2023)

Education

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Institute for Data, Systems, and Society
Ph.D. in Social and Engineering Systems, 2023 (defended September 2022)
- Dissertation: *Local official and polluter accountability in China's environmental inspections*

M.Fin., MIT Sloan School of Management (2017)

Zhejiang University
B.S. in Applied Mathematics (2011–2015)

Fields

Energy and Environmental Policy; Regulation and Policy Implementation
Methods: equilibrium modeling; causal inference; text-as-data methods

Publications

Policy Interactions and the Cost of Decarbonizing Aviation (first author, with Kristen McCormack, William A. Scott, Aaron Smith, Jingran Zhang, and James H. Stock) [link] [code]
Journal of the Association of Environmental and Resource Economists, forthcoming. NBER Working Paper No. 34326.
Policy impact: analysis of California's proposed SAF tax credit with this model was cited by the California Legislative Analyst's Office; covered by E&E News.

Dynamic Responses of SO_2 Pollution to China's Environmental Inspections (co-first author with Valerie J. Karplus) [link] [code]
Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, 2023

Working Papers

Credit Banks, Expectations, and the Cost of Layered Climate Policy: Evidence from U.S. Transportation Fuel
Federal and state climate policies now stack on the same gallon of U.S. transportation fuel. Using a dynamic model of fuel and vehicle markets with investment and credit-price expectations estimated from data, I show that the stack abates at about $180 a tonne, that extending the federal production credit while the federal mandate binds mostly lowers fuel prices and raises emissions, and that California's credit market prices far less scarcity than its statute implies. *Draft available on request.*

Research in Progress

Do State Low Carbon Fuel Standards Complement Federal Biofuel Mandates? (first author, with Kristen McCormack, William A. Scott, Aaron Smith, Jingran Zhang, and James H. Stock)
We study what state clean fuel standards add to federal biofuel mandates and how a state adopting one now should design it, in a model of fuel and vehicle markets with electric vehicle adoption and charging. *To be presented at the APPAM Fall Research Conference, 2026.*

When Inspectors Return: Who Receives Substantive Enforcement?
I study whom local governments penalize when China's central environmental inspectors return. Case records for more than 80,000 citizen complaints across two inspection rounds show that verified complaints against small service businesses became less likely to be escalated to penalties than those against heavy industry, a change that comes at the sanction stage, where local officials have the most discretion. *Presented at the CU Environmental & Resource Economics Workshop, 2026.*

Policy Writing

High Costs and Few Benefits from California's Proposed Sustainable Aviation Fuel Tax Credit (with Aaron Smith, Kristen McCormack, William A. Scott, James H. Stock, and Jingran Zhang) [link]
Energy Institute at Haas Blog, February 2026; cited by the California Legislative Analyst's Office.

Towards Credible and Cost-Effective Options for Sourcing Green Power for Supply Chains in China (with Da Zhang and Valerie J. Karplus) [link]
Policy brief for the Tsinghua Round Table on Corporate Carbon Neutrality Strategies, 2023.

Fellowships

Salata Institute for Climate and Sustainability Postdoctoral Fellowship, Harvard University, 2023–2027
MIT Presidential Fellowship, 2017

Teaching & Advising

Science, Technology and Public Policy, MIT (Spring 2020, Spring 2021)
Teaching Assistant for Professors Noelle Selin and Kenneth Oye; led weekly recitation sections (10–15 students), grading, and research-project mentoring.

The Economic Approach to Cities and Environmental Sustainability, MIT (Fall 2021)
Guest lecture: "Political Economy of Regulating Pollution"

MIT Kaufman Teaching Certificate Program, MIT (Fall 2020)
Designed course curriculum for "Data Science for Decision Making in Public Policy".

Research supervision, Harvard University (2026 – Present)
Supervise undergraduate research assistants on the clean-fuel policy modeling project.

Research supervision, Carnegie Mellon University (2022 – 2023)
Supervised master's research assistants on the Tsinghua green-power supply chain project (interview design, data collection, analysis).

Academic Talks

2027	ASSA Annual Meeting (poster, scheduled)
2026	APPAM Fall Research Conference (scheduled); ENRP/STPP Fellows Seminar, Belfer Center (scheduled); Salata Institute Transportation Lab (scheduled); Tsinghua University; CU Environmental & Resource Economics Workshop; University of Hong Kong; Hong Kong University of Science and Technology; ARCS Research Conference; Renmin University of China; China and Energy Fellows Seminar, Belfer Center; Fudan University; Huazhong University of Science and Technology; Institutional and Organizational Economics Academy; CES NA Annual Conference
2024	ASSA Annual Meeting
2023	ARCS Annual Research Conference
2022	Northeast Workshop on Energy Policy and Environmental Economics
2020–21	Environmental Politics and Governance Conference; Duck Family Graduate Workshop in Environmental Politics and Governance (2020, 2021); Institutional and Organizational Economics Academy; ETH Academy on Sustainability and Technology; China Research Group Doctoral Symposium; Interdisciplinary Ph.D. Workshop in Sustainable Development

Policy & Industry Talks

2026	North American SAF Conference and Expo; International Fuel Ethanol Workshop & Expo
2025	Regional SAF Workshop for Massachusetts and New England
2024	North American SAF Conference and Expo
2023	Roundtable on Corporate Carbon Neutrality Strategies, Tsinghua University

Service

Student organizer, Sloan China Seminar Series, MIT (2017–2020)
Research Collaborator, Sustainable PPE Initiative, MIT (2020–2021)

Languages

English (fluent), Chinese (native)

Software skills

Python, Stata, R, MATLAB, LaTeX

References

Professor James H. Stock
Harvard Department of Economics
79 John F. Kennedy St, Belfer 504
Cambridge, MA 02138
james_stock@harvard.edu

Professor Valerie Karplus
CMU Department of Engineering and Public Policy
5123 Scott Hall, 5000 Forbes Ave
Pittsburgh, PA 15213
vkarplus@andrew.cmu.edu

Professor Aaron Smith
UC Berkeley Department of Agricultural and Resource Economics
207 Giannini Hall
Berkeley, CA 94720
AaronSmith@berkeley.edu